

Jason Herring

DESIGN TECHNOLOGIST / AI + VOICE SYSTEMS / BUILDER

jason@ordinarykids.com linkedin.com/in/ok-jason-herring San Francisco, CA

PROFILE

We're living through the most exciting moment in creative technology — and I'm building at its edge. Design and engineering have collapsed into each other. AI isn't a tool anymore; it's a collaborator, a medium, a new kind of raw material. For the first time, the distance between imagining something and making it real is nearly zero, and I've never felt more capable of building anything I can dream up.

As a Design Technologist at Intuit, I lead experimentation where design, AI, and product vision converge — transforming speculative ideas into high-fidelity prototypes that change how leadership thinks about what's possible. My work lives in that charged space between storytelling and engineering: multimodal intelligence, voice interfaces, and dynamic systems that feel genuinely alive.

I've architected AI-driven personality engines, created lifelike conversational avatars, and led immersive workshops that give creatives and executives hands-on fluency with emerging tech. Whether I'm teaching designers to code or designing systems that feel human, I'm chasing the same question: what happens when intelligence itself becomes a creative medium?

This is the moment. The tools are here. The only limit is what we're willing to prototype. I don't wait for the future — I make it visible. The goal: move beyond imagining the future, and prototype it.

EXPERIENCE

Intuit · Senior Staff Design Technologist and Group Manager, Design — Foresight

FEB 2026 — JUN 2026

Led Design Technology within Foresight, Intuit's 100+ person innovation team, composing agentic systems — multi-agent architectures that orchestrate voice, vision, and ambient intelligence into coherent product experiences.

- Managed builders across multi-modal prototyping and experience innovation, driving rapid experimentation across design, engineering, and AI.
- Architected and shipped agentic systems — autonomous AI agents that reason, act, and collaborate across voice, vision, and data pipelines.
- Delivered flagship demos across executive forums and summits, shifting organizational culture around AI as a creative medium.
- Member of the senior leadership team, reporting directly to Intuit's Chief AI Officer.

Intuit · Senior Staff Design Technologist — AI + Futures

FEB 2025 — FEB 2026

Key builder on Futures, a 100+ person innovation team. The interfaces of the future won't live on a single screen — they'll flow across devices, voices, and contexts. I led rapid experimentation to discover what that actually feels like.

- Built high-fidelity provocations for leadership — functional prototypes showing how voice, vision, and ambient intelligence could reshape financial interactions with real data, natural language, and multi-device ecosystems.
- Designed and built a real-time AI personality engine from the ground up — a living framework where natural language, emotional intelligence, and embodied avatars converge.
- Pioneered ultra-low-latency conversational pipelines (Vapi, Hume AI, LiveKit, HeyGen), creating character-driven agents that don't just respond — they communicate, emotionally present.
- Delivered flagship demos across executive forums and built learning experiences — Demystifying Python, Shipping Conversations, AI Avatars and Voice — that seeded organization-wide momentum.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- Conversational AI / Voice / Multi-Modal
- Generative AI / LLMs / RAG
- Prompt Engineering
- AI Personality & Agentic Systems
- Real-Time Voice Pipelines (Vapi, LiveKit, Hume, HeyGen)
- Rapid Prototyping / High-Fidelity Provocation
- Multi-Modal Interfaces / Voice UI
- Design Systems / Interaction Design / Figma
- Python / TypeScript / React / Next.js / Node.js
- API Design / Real-Time Systems
- Innovation Strategy / Design Technology Leadership
- Workshop Facilitation / Executive Communication

SELECT CLIENTS

Intuit · Nike · MoMA · Adidas · Stüssy · UNDFTD · Vans OTW · Pepsi · DreamWorks · KQED · HUF · The North Face · Rebel8 · BART · Tracy Chapman / Elektra Records · Aesop Rock / Def Jux · Arta Tequila · Exploratorium

Intuit · Staff Design Technologist — AI + Futures

APR 2024 — FEB 2025

Built functional prototypes exploring how voice, vision, and ambient intelligence could change financial interactions — turning speculative ideas into tools leadership could actually use.

- Built multi-modal prototypes with real data, natural language, and multi-device flows across design, engineering, and AI.
- Designed and built real-time conversational pipelines from scratch — low-latency, character-driven, emotionally present (Vapi, Hume AI, LiveKit, HeyGen).
- Delivered demos at executive forums and built hands-on workshops to help teams start building with AI — Demystifying Python, Shipping Conversations, AI Avatars and Voice.

Aleph · Director of Design and Technology

MAR 2020 — APR 2024

Creative and technical leadership for an enterprise development studio. Managed engineering, design, and client relationships across React, React Native, Node, WordPress, and UX engagements.

- Increased annual revenue by more than 85% over four years through new client acquisition and expanded scopes.
- Directed a mobile app for Helix clinical trials — notifications, dashboards, and protocol compliance tools that increased user acquisition success by 22%.
- Led a complete studio rebrand: logo, typography, color, brand guidelines, and AI-assisted creative direction using Midjourney.
- Built and managed a team of 8 engineers and 3 designers across multiple concurrent client engagements.
- Introduced AI workflows (ChatGPT, Midjourney, Stable Diffusion) into the studio’s design and development process.

KQED · Director of Digital Design and Development

AUG 2018 — MAR 2020

Modernized how public media connects with its audience — leading design and technology that transformed KQED.org and the systems behind it. Focused on prototyping, modernization, and building the technical foundation for new kinds of storytelling.

- Led the multi-year redesign of KQED.org, partnering with design, engineering, product, and AlephSF to build a modern, accessible platform for public media in the Bay Area.
- Rebuilt the CI/CD pipeline, migrating Docker containers from AWS to Kubernetes on Google Cloud — enabling canary deployments, instant rollbacks, and faster experimentation.
- Migrated KQED’s massive WordPress CMS to GCP Kubernetes, powering hundreds of thousands of articles and partner feeds (NPR, Apple News, Google News).
- Designed automated audio workflows for Alexa, Google Assistant, and NPR One — normalizing audio levels and publishing segmented clips for emerging voice platforms.
- Created real-time election infrastructure across every Bay Area county for 2018 — scrapers, editorial workflows, and automated publishing that made coverage fast and reliable.

EDUCATION

University of South Florida, Tampa

English Literature

Dropped out senior year. Fell in love with the library and discovered the internet.

Hillsborough Community College, Tampa

Associate of Arts

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- How Magazine — Best of Show, Interactive Annual
- FWA — Site of the Day (multiple)
- Communication Arts — Interactive Annual
- Print Magazine — MoMA Design Takes on Risk
- One Club — Judge
- Featured in History of Web Design (Taschen)

REFERENCES

- Jodi Twilleger

— ECD — Collins, Magic Leap, Hush
- Justin Marr

— Design Director — Uber, Intuit
- Phoupphet Sihavong

— Director, Applied AI — Intuit
- Tim Olson

— SVP Strategic Partnerships — KQED

KQED · Lead UX Designer

JAN 2015 — AUG 2018

Helped transform KQED's digital presence from a traditional broadcaster into a modern, audience-driven media platform — blending UX strategy, product design, and hands-on prototyping for millions of listeners and readers.

- The Listening Project: led a complete redesign of KQED Radio, News, Arts, Science, and the homepage — a persistent audio player, a flexible editorial content system, and a real-time “trending” experience.
- 2016 Election Voter Guide: spearheaded one of the first single-page apps deployed by a public media org — a custom WordPress-to-Elasticsearch pipeline and React front end that became a model for civic engagement design across NPR member stations.
- Prototyped and built a real-time election dashboard that drew 1M+ views on election night 2016.
- WordPress Modernization: migrated KQED's core properties into WordPress — first as an external vendor, then full-time — unifying content management and design across teams.

OrdinaryKids · Founder & Creative Director

JAN 2001 — JAN 2015

Formed in the midst of the dot-com fallout, OrdinaryKids produced over a decade of award-winning, thought-provoking work. By building mostly direct-to-client relationships, the studio shaped and augmented brands across the skate, architecture, and fashion worlds.

- Clients included MoMA, Nike NSW, Adidas Skateboarding, Arta Tequila, Aesop Rock, Tracy Chapman, Rebel8, The North Face, Stüssy, HUF, and BART.
- Created an animated coloring-book web experience for Tracy Chapman / Elektra Records — recognized by Communication Arts and FWA.
- Designed and developed an ecommerce experience for Stüssy in Flash and Magento — one of the last great Flash sites.
- Directed the music video for Aesop Rock's “None Shall Pass” — hand-drawn illustration meets digital animation.
- Founded OKML, a 6-week Arduino workshop for creatives that culminated in gallery exhibitions.

DualForces · Partner & Creative Director

SEP 2010 — DEC 2013

A creative application studio working at the intersection of fashion, streetwear, and emerging culture — designing experiences that move fluidly between digital, physical, and cinematic worlds, merging art direction, technology, and cultural storytelling into one practice.

- Creative-directed the Nike Free visual center — the first public use of real Nike+ data in a marketing campaign — and produced a 56-page zine shot in London, NYC, and Tokyo.
- Ran the Nike FuelBand influencer campaign in NYC: 60+ events in 90 days with a large content team.
- Collaborated with Nike, Stüssy, UNDFTD, Vans OTW, Pepsi, DreamWorks, and SA Studios — work spanning digital products, retail environments, and large-scale installations.
- Produced a microsite and directed six short films for Nike NSW (Sportswear).